

Madison Lam

ENGR 106

Putting the Pieces Together: Laser Cutting a Puzzle

November 3, 2025



Full Puzzle: 10x12 with different tab sizes (slightly jumbled since pieces are quite small)



Zoom up: two pieces featuring one of the person's face (left photo)

In this workshop, we learned about the laser cutter itself, how to use it in the Mill at UW as well as applications of the machine in the various areas of impact for engineering. First, we started with going over the safety features and how to gain access to the laser cutter when visiting the mill and then making our own initial design and making our 4x4 puzzle. To design the puzzle, we used a puzzle template generator and then adobe illustrator to put the puzzle template on top of our chosen image. Next, we uploaded our design, set up the laser cutter and finally, our puzzle was made. It was interesting to learn about the usages of laser cutters in an industry setting or other projects outside of personal use, including research, models and test designs. In the future, I would like to apply my credibility of using the laser cutter to potentially make more puzzles in the future or other models. I saw from the scrap pile that previous projects included mini models for an architecture class. To develop next, I would like to see what other sorts of projects I could work with on the laser cutter, maybe using the machine for future research as well.